

The UI Postgraduate EPT

What the Test of English covers, how it is scored, and how to prepare

Study guide for the University of Ibadan Postgraduate Test of English (EPT)

What the EPT is

Applicants to Master's and Postgraduate Diploma programmes at the University of Ibadan sit a **Test of English for Higher Degree Admissions**, usually called the EPT. It checks that you can read and write English at the level a graduate student needs. The Postgraduate School introduced it because many graduate students struggled to express themselves clearly in writing.

100

questions

60

minutes

40%

needed to move forward

Candidates who score **40% or above** can be considered further. Some departments then set their own **Department-based Postgraduate Test (DPT)** or interview; others move straight to departmental recommendation. Whether a department runs a DPT can change from one session to the next.

NOTE

These details come from applicant reports and past guidance, not an official UI publication. Always confirm current arrangements with the Postgraduate College Admission Office and your department.

The syllabus

The Postgraduate School's own sample booklet lists six areas. Every practice paper on this platform follows the same order.

Section	Area	What it tests
A	Parallelism	Keeping items in a series or comparison in the same grammatical form.
B	Discourse reference	Knowing what words like <i>this, it, that, one</i> and <i>do</i> refer back to (cohesion and coherence).
C	Stylistic variation	Choosing language that suits the context: formal or informal, Standard British English rather than local usage, active or passive.
D	Concord	Subject–verb agreement, including the rule of proximity and tricky nouns.
E	Mechanics	Spelling, capitalisation and punctuation.
F	Vocabulary	Word choice, collocation, registers of different disciplines, synonyms, antonyms, ambiguity, tense and aspect.

How the booklet rates performance

The sample booklet suggests converting your score to a percentage and rating yourself on each attempt:

Score	Rating
85–100	Highly proficient
70–84	Proficient
60–69	Fairly proficient
50–59	Scarcely proficient
40–49	Not proficient
0–39	Illiterate

A study plan that works

1. **Take one practice set cold.** Note your score and which sections cost you marks.
2. **Read the matching guide.** Each weak section has a guide in these E-Resources: concord, capitalisation, parallelism, stylistic variation and spelling.
3. **Use the topic drills.** They give instant feedback and an explanation after every answer, which is the fastest way to fix a habit.
4. **Take the next practice set under time.** Aim to finish 50 questions in 30 minutes, the same pace as the real test.
5. **Review every wrong answer.** The review page shows the correct option; ask yourself which rule you missed.

EXAM TIP

Standard British English is the reference. Where local Nigerian usage and British usage differ, the exam expects the British form: *in the office*, not *on seat*.

On test day

- Read the instruction at the top of each section. The same sentence can be right in one section and wrong in another (for example, contractions in an informal letter).
- Do not spend long on one question. Flag it, move on and come back.
- Eliminate options you know are wrong first; you are often left with two to compare.
- Answer every question. There is no reason to leave a blank unless you are told wrong answers carry a penalty.

UI PG Practice Tests is an independent exam-preparation service and is not affiliated with the University of Ibadan. This guide is for personal study.